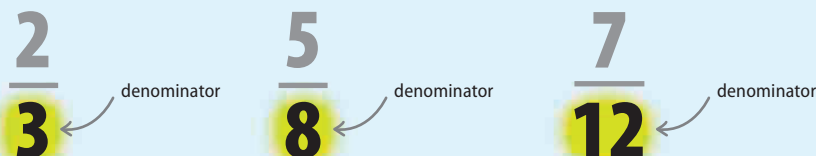


Finding a common denominator

When finding the relative sizes of two or more fractions, finding a common denominator makes it much easier. A common denominator is a number that can be divided exactly by the denominators of all of the fractions. Once this has been found, comparing fractions is just a matter of comparing their numerators.

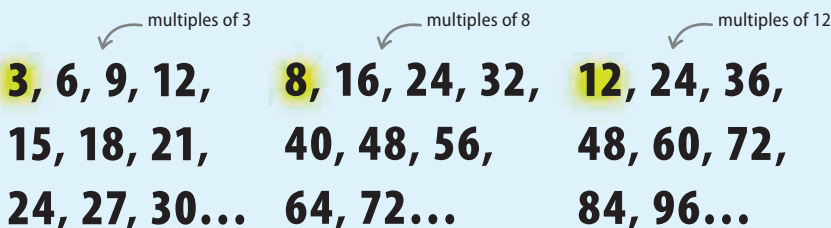
▷ Comparing fractions

To work out the relative sizes of fractions, it is necessary to convert them so that they all have the same denominator. To do so, first look at the denominators of all the fractions being compared.



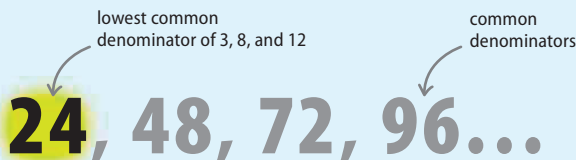
▷ Make a list

List the multiples – all the whole number products of each denominator – for all of the denominators. Pick a sensible stopping point for the list, such as 100.



▷ Find the lowest common denominator

List only the multiples that are common to all three sets. These numbers are called common denominators. Identify the lowest one.



▷ Convert the fractions

Find out how many times the original denominator goes into the common denominator. Multiply the numerator by the same number. It is now possible to compare the fractions.

